MERCY'S ANATOMY

Season 2, Episode 7

"Something to Talk About"

Episode 2x07. The counterpart of *Grey's Anatomy* 2x07. Narrator: Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock

In-story dates: Friday, November 4, 2005, 5:51 AM through 11:56 PM

Script: Cold Open + 5 Acts + Tag. 41 scenes. Standard: MA-009

Depends on MA-001 through MA-011 and episodes 1x01-2x06

EPISODE PDF PACKAGE (MA-009 §6): 1. Title page and cast (with ages on Friday, November 4, 2005). 2. Script. 3. Media Companion. 4. Continuity Sheet.

Cast in Order of Appearance (Ages on Friday, November 4, 2005)

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Dr. Bryce Kennerly	Surgical Intern (on probation)	Jun 11, 1978	27
Nurse Kendra Wallace	Surgical Floor Nurse	May 30, 1980	25
Dr. Philip Grant (new)	Medicine Resident	Mar 13, 1976	29
Josephine 'Grandma Jo' Bullock (on-screen debut)	Marc's paternal grandmother	Jan 19, 1931	74
Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock	Surgical Intern (narrator)	Jan 5, 1979	26
Dr. Raven Ellison	Surgical Intern	Dec 3, 1979	25
Dr. Harmony Divine	Surgical Intern	Jun 19, 1979	26
Dr. Amond Baker	Surgical Intern (back from leave)	Feb 10, 1979	26
Dr. Arianna Cummings	Surgical Intern (26 since Oct 25)	Oct 25, 1979	26
Dr. Elxa Bullock	Surgical Resident (26 weeks pregnant)	Aug 29, 1977	28
Dr. Isaiah Crump	Chief of Pediatric Surgery	Mar 11, 1944	61
Dr. Clayton Hartwell	Fetal Surgeon	Mar 3, 1971	34
Bernard 'Bunny' Washington (new)	Patient: fetus in fetu	Apr 19, 1973	32
Bernadette 'Bernie' Watkins	Executive Assistant to the Chief	Jun 6, 1950	55
Dr. Natasha Donohue	Chief of Surgery	Jun 2, 1958	47
Franklin Bassett, Esq.	General Counsel	Oct 28, 1958	47
Nadia Ellerbe	Patient: chorioamnionitis, cesarean at 30w6d	Apr 25, 1977	28
Malik Ellerbe	Nadia's husband	Jan 30, 1975	30
Raymond 'Big Ray' Toles	Chief of Security	Jan 1, 1960	45
Dr. Abraham Lowery	Attending General Surgeon	Jan 9, 1947	58
Dr. Esther Smilley	Surgical Intern	Sep 20, 1979	26
Nurse Gloria Pettiford	Head ER Nurse	Apr 14, 1952	53
Dr. Camille Toussaint	Orthopedic Resident	Jul 21, 1976	29
Dr. Robert Bullock	Chief of Cardiothoracic Surgery	Feb 10, 1956	49
Dr. Leland Graves	Chief of Neurosurgery	Apr 18, 1953	52
Eddie (new)	Monty's regular	Aug 8, 1965	40
Lamont 'Monty' Gaines	Owner, Monty's on Jackson	Oct 10, 1962	43
Dr. Horace Whitlow	Chief of Medicine	Sep 19, 1949	56
Dr. Grace Bullock (V.O.)	Harvard Medical School student; Marc's sister	Apr 12, 1981	24

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Dr. Victor Donohue (V.O.)	Marc's grandfather	May 30, 1933	72

Also appearing: Miss Hattie Lomax, two floor nurses, an L&D; nurse, a NICU team, a circulating nurse, a lobby volunteer and Malik Ellerbe Jr. (born today, 3 lb 2 oz). Mentioned: Rosa Parks, Malcolm Sloan, Corinne Smilley, Augustin Toussaint, Tyrell Pickens (by postcard), Walter Bullock and Bunny's late mother.

COLD OPEN

1 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CAFETERIA - DAWN
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 5:51 AM

The cafeteria at shift change, half asleep. Miss Hattie Lomax (60) slides trays of eggs into the steam table. At a corner table: Kennerly (27), a coffee, and two people leaning in to listen: NURSE KENDRA WALLACE (25) and a sleepy medicine resident, DR. PHILIP GRANT (29).

KENNERLY
(low, delighted)
I'm not saying anything. (beat) I'm just saying a member of the board told someone who told me.

KENDRA
(skeptical)
Told you what?

KENNERLY
(sipping his coffee)
That Bullock is the Chief's son.

Kendra puts her fork down.

DR. GRANT
(waking up)
Bullock-Bullock? Dimples? The one who held the aorta?

KENNERLY
(pleasantly)
Robert Bullock's son. Natasha Donohue's son. (beat) Victor Donohue's grandson. (beat) Collegiate School, class of '97. Look it up.

KENDRA
(slowly)
"Bullock's a common name."

KENNERLY
(standing, picking up his tray)
Apparently not that common.

He walks off. Kendra and Dr. Grant look at each other. Behind the steam table, Miss Hattie has stopped moving, a ladle in her hand.

MARC (V.O.)
A hospital is a building full of people who keep secrets for a living.

2 INT. AMTRAK NORTHEAST REGIONAL - COACH CAR - DAWN
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 6:04 AM

A train rolling north through New Jersey in the gray dawn. In a window seat, upright as a church pew: JOSEPHINE "GRANDMA JO" BULLOCK (74), retired D.C. schoolteacher, in a black wool coat with a small mourning pin on the lapel. On her lap: a foil-wrapped pound cake the size of a hubcap, and a funeral program. On its cover: a photograph of Rosa Parks. "A CELEBRATION OF LIFE. METROPOLITAN A.M.E. CHURCH, WASHINGTON, D.C."

She takes out a little silver flip phone, holds it at arm's length and dials with one deliberate finger.

GRANDMA JO
(into the phone, loudly)
Marc-Anthony. It's your grandmother. (beat) I'm on the train. (beat) The train to you, baby. Where else would I be on a train?

MARC (V.O.)
Patients' secrets. Families' secrets. Our own.

GRANDMA JO
(into the phone)
I'll be at Penn Station at nine-thirty. I want to see Elxa's belly and I want to see your face. (beat) Don't tell me you're busy. I buried Rosa Parks this week. You can make time for your grandmother.

MARC (V.O.)
And every one of us knows the truth about secrets. (beat) They're only secrets until somebody needs something to talk about.

END OF COLD OPEN

ACT ONE

3 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - MORNING
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 6:09 AM

Marc (26), in scrubs, stands frozen in the middle of the kitchen with his phone at his ear. Raven (25) eats cereal. Harmony (26) makes grits. Amond (26), back at work for ten days, his color restored, reads the Times.

MARC
(into the phone, faintly)
Grandma. (beat) Grandma, I'm working all day. (beat) Yes, ma'am. (beat) Yes, ma'am. (beat) No, ma'am, I would never. (beat) Nine-thirty. Penn Station. (beat) I love you too.

He hangs up. He stares at the phone.

RAVEN
(chewing)
Your grandma?

MARC
(beat)
My grandmother.

HARMONY
(stirring)
From D.C.? The one who used to send you care packages at Howard?

MARC
(beat)
She's coming to New York. (beat) Today. (beat) With a pound cake.

RAVEN
(delighted)
We get to meet your grandma?

Marc looks at Amond. Amond looks back over the top of the Times with an expression of profound, silent sympathy.

AMOND
(dry)
The bus driver's widow.

MARC
(very quietly)
The bus driver's widow.

RAVEN
(looking between them)
Why are you both being weird?

AMOND
(going back to his paper)
I'm always weird, Ellison. (beat) He's having a bad morning.

4 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - THE BOARD - DAY
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 6:30 AM

The interns gather. Something is different. A cluster of nurses at the station stop talking when Marc walks in. Two residents glance at him and look away. Kendra, behind the

desk, very carefully doesn't look at him at all.

Esther (26), at her end of the Board, notices. Arianna (26), birthday a week behind her, notices. Marc notices too. He doesn't know what it means yet.

ARIANNA
(low, to Marc)
Why is everybody looking at you like you've got something on your face?

MARC
(low)
I don't know.

Elxa (28), twenty-six weeks and very pregnant, waddles in with charts. She sees the nurses' faces. She sees Kendra. Her eyes narrow. She doesn't say a word about it.

ELXA
Assignments. (beat) Bullock: Dr. Hartwell and Dr. Crump. Thirty-two-year-old man with a lifelong abdominal mass. The CT's on the light box and I'm not going to describe it. You'll want to see it yourself. (beat) Smilley: Graves. Divine: ortho, with Toussaint. (beat) Ellison, Cummings: Lowery. (beat) Baker: Dr. Bullock, Senior.

As the interns scatter, Elxa catches Marc's arm. Very low.

ELXA
(low)
Kendra's been on her phone since six. (beat) Something's out.

MARC
(beat, low)
Grandma's on the Amtrak.

ELXA
(closing her eyes)
Today?

MARC
Nine-thirty. Penn Station.

ELXA
(beat)
Of course she is.

5 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - TRAUMA 4 - DAY
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 6:57 AM

BERNARD "BUNNY" WASHINGTON (32), a lanky, funny barber from Harlem with a perfect fade and a BARBER LIFE T-shirt stretched tight over a hard, oddly shaped belly, sits on the gurney. Clayton (34), Crump (61) and Marc study a CT on the light box. On the screen: a large, round mass in his abdomen. Inside it, unmistakably: a tiny spine. Small curved bones. Something that looks like a limb.

MARC
(staring)
That's a vertebral column.

CRUMP
(dryly)
It is.

MARC
And those are... (beat) Those are long bones. Femurs.

CLAYTON
(quietly)
And a skull base. Calcified. (beat) Teeth.

Bunny watches them from the gurney.

BUNNY
(cheerful)
Docs. (beat) Y'all are looking at that picture like I'm pregnant.

CLAYTON
(turning to him, careful)
Mr. Washington. When did you first notice your stomach was bigger than it should be?

BUNNY
Since I was a baby. My mama said I was always a big-bellied boy. (beat) It's gotten bigger the last year. It's pushing on my lungs. I can't get up the stairs to my shop on Lenox without stopping.

CRUMP
(gently)
Mr. Washington, did your mother ever tell you whether she was expecting twins? When she was carrying you?

Bunny's smile fades.

BUNNY
(beat)
How'd you know that?

CRUMP
(beat)
Did she?

BUNNY
(slowly)
The doctor at Harlem Hospital told her twins. Early. At her first appointment. (beat) Then later they said they were wrong. Just me. (beat) She always said the other one went back to God.

Clayton and Crump exchange a look.

CLAYTON
(quietly)
Mr. Washington. I don't think your twin went anywhere.

6 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF'S OFFICE - DAY
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 7:21 AM

Natasha (47) at her desk. Bernie (55) stands in front of it. Franklin Bassett (46) stands at the window.

BERNIE
(grim)
It's in the cafeteria. It's at the third-floor nurses' station. It's at the second-floor nurses' station. (beat) Kendra Wallace told the night pharmacist, and the night pharmacist told the respiratory therapists, and you know what happens when respiratory knows something.

NATASHA
(very still)
Who started it?

BERNIE
(beat)
Dr. Kennerly. Five fifty-one a.m. Miss Hattie heard every word.

NATASHA
(to Bassett)
The trustees signed nondisclosure agreements, Franklin.

BASSETT
(carefully)
The trustees did. (beat) Department chiefs who were present to present a motion were not asked to sign. (beat) Horace is under no legal obligation to keep anything confidential. (beat) And he'll say he never said a word to anyone.

NATASHA
(beat)
And Kennerly will say he heard it "from someone."

BASSETT
(beat)
From a board member, apparently. Which is exactly the lie that protects Horace. (beat) If we accuse a trustee of leaking, they'll all be insulted. If we accuse Horace, he'll say we're paranoid. (beat) It's well done, Tasha.

Natasha stands up and goes to the window. Below, the morning shift streams into the hospital.

NATASHA
(quietly)
He doesn't need the board anymore. (beat) He just needs the cafeteria.

7 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - ROOM 6 - DAY
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 7:43 AM

Nadia Ellerbe (28) lies in the bed she's been in for a month, flushed and sweating, shivering under a blanket. Her husband Malik (30), his right forearm healed now under a pressure garment, holds her hand. Clayton examines her belly. She winces.

CLAYTON
(pressing gently)
Tender. (beat) Temperature?

NURSE
One-oh-one point four. Maternal heart rate one-sixteen. Fetal heart rate one-seventy-five.

Marc, coming in from the Pit, hears the numbers and stops.

CLAYTON
(quietly, to Nadia)
Mrs. Ellerbe. You have an infection inside your uterus. Chorioamnionitis. (beat) It's what we've been watching for every four hours for twenty-seven days. (beat) Thirty weeks and six days. (beat) It's time.

NADIA
(frightened)
Thirty weeks. Is that enough?

MARC
(coming to the bedside)
Thirty weeks is a lot better than twenty-six, Mrs. Ellerbe. (beat) Thirty weeks is a baby who breathes with a little help and goes home by Christmas.

MALIK
(beat)
By Christmas?

CLAYTON
(nodding)
By Christmas, if he's a typical thirty-weeker. (beat) A C-section. This morning. (beat) Today you meet your son.

Nadia starts to cry. Malik kisses her forehead.

MALIK
(to Marc, low)
You'll be there?

MARC
(beat)
I'll be there.

8 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - CORRIDOR OUTSIDE THE NURSES' STATION - DAY
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 8:06 AM

Raven comes around the corner with a chart and slows near the nurses' station, where two NURSES are talking in low voices, their backs to her.

NURSE ONE
(low)
...the Chief's son. Kendra swears. (beat) And Dr. Elxa Bullock's brother.

NURSE TWO
(low)
That's why he gets all the good cases.

NURSE ONE
(low)
He doesn't get them because of that. He gets them because he's good. (beat) But still. (beat) Can you imagine? Victor Donohue's grandson, living in Hunters Point with roommates?

Raven stops dead. The chart in her hand dips. The nurses turn around and see her. They fall silent, guilty.

Raven walks past them very fast without a word. Down the corridor. Around the corner. Into the stairwell.

9 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - STAIRWELL B - DAY
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 8:09 AM

Harmony, on her way up from the Pit with a splint kit, nearly collides with Raven, who is standing on the landing, pale, her back against the wall.

HARMONY
Rave? (beat) What's wrong?

RAVEN
(barely)
It's everywhere, Harmony. (beat) The nurses on six. Kendra. (beat) "The Chief's son." (beat) "Elxa Bullock's brother." (beat) "Victor Donohue's grandson."

Harmony goes very still. The splint kit hangs from her hand.

HARMONY
(slowly)
Dr. Donohue. (beat) The Mercedes. (beat) "A friend of the hospital."

RAVEN
(beat)
The Mercedes. "My brother." (beat) The man in the suit with the envelopes. The "Yes, sir" calls on the porch. (beat) Bullock's a common name. (beat) It's all true.

HARMONY
(quietly)
We said we'd wait. (beat) He said "soon." We said we'd wait for him to tell us.

RAVEN
(her voice breaking)
Harmony, the night pharmacist knew before we did. (beat) Respiratory knew before we did. (beat) We live with him. (beat) Everybody in this building is hearing it before us.

Harmony looks at her. Then at the stairwell door. Somewhere above them, Marc is scrubbing in on a baby who's coming eight weeks early, with no idea.

END OF ACT ONE

ACT TWO

10 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - OR 1 - DAY
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 8:34 AM

A cesarean under spinal anesthesia. Nadia, awake behind the drape, Malik at her head in a paper gown. Clayton operates. Marc assists. A NICU team waits by the warmer.

CLAYTON
(working)
Through the old hysterotomy scar.
(beat) Careful. It's adhered.
(beat) There.

He reaches in and lifts out a small, limp, purple baby boy. Three pounds. And at the base of his tiny spine: a neat, healed, curving scar, where four weeks ago, in this same uterus, Crump cut away a tumor half his size.

MARC
(very quietly)
Look at that.

CLAYTON
(holding the baby for one second longer than he needs to)
I see it.

He hands the baby to the NICU team. A long, frightening silence. Then a thin, furious cry.

NICU NURSE
He's crying! (beat) Apgars five and eight. (beat) Three pounds two ounces.

Behind the drape, Nadia sobs. Malik buries his face in her shoulder.

NADIA
(crying)
Malik Junior. (beat) Malik Junior.

MALIK
(crying)
Told you he'd be tough. (beat) Two operations before he was even born.

Marc looks across the field at Clayton. Clayton is watching the warmer. His eyes, above the mask, are wet.

CLAYTON
(quietly, not looking at Marc)
First open fetal I've done that I got to meet.

MARC
(beat)
You'll meet a lot of them, Dr. Hartwell.

11 EXT. PENN STATION - EIGHTH AVENUE ENTRANCE - DAY
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 9:38 AM

The crush of Penn Station at rush hour. Grandma Jo comes up the escalator with her pound cake, her funeral program and a small suitcase, looking around for her grandson. Instead, waiting at the top of the escalator: Big Ray (45), six-foot-seven, in a suit, holding a small hand-lettered sign: "MRS. J. BULLOCK."

GRANDMA JO
(stopping, suspicious)
Who are you?

BIG RAY
(gently)
Raymond Toles, ma'am. Chief of Security at Queens Grace. (beat) Your daughter-in-law sent me. Dr. Marc-Anthony is in surgery delivering a baby, and Dr. Elxa is twenty-six weeks pregnant and not allowed to stand on train platforms.

GRANDMA JO
(narrowing her eyes, looking him up and down)
Natasha sent you.

BIG RAY
Yes, ma'am.

GRANDMA JO
(beat)
Natasha never once sent anybody to pick me up at Union Station. (beat) She must be scared of something.

BIG RAY
(taking her suitcase, very carefully not reacting)
I wouldn't know, ma'am.

GRANDMA JO
(handing him the pound cake too)
Baby, you're a terrible liar. (beat) Carry that like it's a newborn. It's a seven-up pound cake and it's older than you.

12 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 3 - DAY
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 9:52 AM

A laparoscopic cholecystectomy. Lowery (58) at the monitors. Raven and Arianna assisting, each on a port. Raven has said nothing for twenty minutes. Arianna glances at her over her mask, twice.

LOWERY
(working)
Critical view of safety. (beat)
Cystic duct, cystic artery. Two structures, no more. (beat)
Ellison. Clip.

Raven clips. Her hands are fine. Her face isn't.

ARIANNA
(low)
Rave. (beat) What's wrong?

RAVEN
(low, not looking at her)
Not here.

LOWERY
(dry, not looking up)
If you two are going to have a lovers' quarrel, do it after the gallbladder's out.

Both women freeze. Lowery keeps operating.

LOWERY
(mildly)
I've been doing this since 1979. I know what a lovers' quarrel looks like over a mask. (beat)
Cut.

RAVEN
(cutting, very low)
Everybody's saying Marc is the Chief's son. (beat) Victor Donohue's grandson.

Arianna's hand, on the grasper, goes completely still. Raven sees it.

RAVEN
(quietly)
You knew.

Arianna doesn't answer. That's an answer.

RAVEN
(beat)
How long?

ARIANNA
(very low)
August ninth. (beat) I saw Victor hug him outside Kingston's room.

LOWERY
(dry)
Gallbladder's out. Now you may quarrel.

13 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - FETAL THERAPY OFFICE - DAY
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 10:09 AM

Clayton, scrubbed out, sits at his desk writing the op note. Esther knocks and comes in. She's heard about the Ellerbe baby. She smiles at him.

ESTHER
Three pounds two.

CLAYTON
(looking up, his face soft)
Three pounds two. (beat) He cried, Es. (beat) He has a scar on his back the length of my finger, from before he was born.

She sits on the edge of his desk. A beat. Then Clayton puts down his pen.

CLAYTON
(carefully)
Full disclosure.

ESTHER
(beat)
Okay.

CLAYTON
(beat)
Malcolm called me. Last night. At eleven-fifteen. (beat) I didn't pick up. He left a message.

Esther goes very still.

CLAYTON
(beat)
He's been offered a position. NYU. Plastic and reconstructive surgery. He's thinking about taking it. (beat) He wanted to know if... (beat) He wanted to know if you'd want him in New York.

A long, long silence.

ESTHER
(finally, quietly)
Thank you for telling me.

CLAYTON
(beat)
You said the day it happens. (beat) It happened at eleven-fifteen.

ESTHER
(beat, standing)
Tell him no. (beat) Tell him I don't want him in New York. (beat) Not yet. (beat) Maybe not ever.

CLAYTON
(beat)
I'll tell him.

ESTHER
(at the door, not turning around)
And Clayton. (beat) Thank you for not picking up.

14 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - TRAUMA 4 - DAY
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 10:20 AM

Bunny Washington, in a gown now, a consent form on his lap. Crump sits beside the bed. Marc stands at the foot, back from the C-section.

CRUMP
Fetus in fetu, Mr. Washington. (beat) It's very rare. About one in half a million births. (beat) Very early in your mother's pregnancy, you and your twin were joined. You grew. He didn't. (beat) Somehow you wrapped around him. And he's been inside your abdomen for thirty-two years.

Bunny is quiet for a long moment.

BUNNY
(finally)
Is he alive?

CRUMP
(gently)
No, son. He was never alive the way you are. He has no heart of his own, no brain. He's lived off your blood vessels. (beat) But he has some bones. Some hair. Teeth. (beat) He's been growing, slowly, and now he's pressing on your lungs.

BUNNY
(beat, half laughing, half something else)
Thirty-two years. (beat) My mama said the other one went back to God. (beat) He was in here with me the whole time.

MARC
(quietly)
He was.

BUNNY
(looking at the consent form)
And you're going to take him out.

CRUMP
This afternoon. (beat) Dr. Hartwell, Dr. Bullock and I.

Bunny signs the form. Then he looks up at Marc.

BUNNY
(beat, a sad grin)
Y'all are going to have something to talk about at dinner tonight.

MARC
(beat)
Mr. Washington, in this hospital, people already have plenty to talk about.

15 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - JACKSON AVENUE ENTRANCE - LOBBY - DAY
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 10:41 AM

The busy lobby. Big Ray holds the revolving door. Grandma Jo walks in with her funeral program, looks around the lobby the way a schoolteacher looks around a new classroom and marches to the information desk. Behind her, Big Ray carries the pound cake.

GRANDMA JO
(to the VOLUNTEER at the desk, loudly)
Good morning. I'm here to see my granddaughter, Dr. Elxa Bullock. (beat) And my grandson, Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock.

The volunteer looks up, wide-eyed. At the coffee cart by the elevator, three nurses turn around in unison. One of them is Kendra.

BIG RAY
(quietly, behind her)
Mrs. Bullock, maybe we should...

The elevator doors open. Marc steps out, still in his OR cap, coming down to meet her. He sees her. He sees the nurses. He sees Kendra's face. He freezes.

GRANDMA JO
(lighting up, opening her arms, at full Washington, D.C. schoolteacher volume)
MARC-ANTHONY! (beat) Come here, baby! Come give your grandmother some sugar!

The whole lobby is watching. Marc crosses it slowly, like a man walking to his own execution, and lets his grandmother wrap him in a hug that smells of Shalimar and church.

GRANDMA JO
(kissing both his cheeks)
Look at you. (beat) Look at you in your little doctor hat. (beat) Your grandfather would bust. (beat) Where's your sister? Where's Elxa? I want to see that belly.

MARC
(muffled, against her shoulder)
Hi, Grandma.

Over his grandmother's shoulder, he meets Kendra's eyes. Kendra looks away.

And up on the mezzanine above the lobby, leaning on the brass rail: Whitlow, in his three-piece suit, coffee in hand, watching. He smiles.

16 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF'S OFFICE - DAY
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 11:02 AM

Grandma Jo sits in Natasha's visitor's chair with her pound cake on the desk. Natasha, behind the desk, has the expression of a woman simultaneously delighted and terrified. Elxa (28) lowers herself onto the couch. Bernie closes the door.

GRANDMA JO
(to Elxa)
Twenty-six weeks. (beat) You're carrying high. It's a boy.

ELXA
(dry)
Russell has the sealed card, Grandma.

GRANDMA JO
I don't need a card, baby. I've been looking at bellies since 1949. (beat) It's a boy.

She turns to Natasha.

GRANDMA JO
(beat)
Natasha. Why did a man the size of a refrigerator pick me up at Penn Station?

NATASHA
(carefully)
Josephine...

GRANDMA JO
(beat)
Something's happened. (beat) In that lobby, half the nurses looked at my grandson like he'd grown a second head. (beat) What did I do?

Natasha and Elxa exchange a look.

NATASHA
(quietly)
You didn't do anything, Josephine. (beat) This morning, somebody started a rumor in the cafeteria. That Marc is my son. (beat) You just... confirmed it. In the lobby. At full volume.

Grandma Jo sits back. She looks at the funeral program in her lap: Rosa Parks's calm face.

GRANDMA JO
(finally)
Good.

NATASHA
(startled)
Good?

GRANDMA JO
(firm)
Good. (beat) Natasha, I stood in line for four hours in the cold outside the Capitol rotunda on Sunday to say goodbye to a woman who changed this country by refusing to pretend. (beat) For five months, my grandson has been pretending his grandfather drove a bus. (beat) His grandfather did drive a bus. For thirty years. (beat) And his other grandfather is Victor Donohue. (beat) Both of those are true, and neither of them is anything to be ashamed of.

Silence in the office.

ELXA
(quietly)
Grandma, he didn't want people to treat him differently.

GRANDMA JO
(beat)
I know, baby. (beat) But somebody just made it a secret, and secrets are something to talk about. (beat) The truth's just the truth.

17 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - NURSES' STATION - DAY
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 11:34 AM

Grandma Jo, on her way to the cafeteria with Big Ray as escort, stops at the Pit's nurses' station because a woman behind it is barking orders at three residents at once. Gloria (53). The two women look at each other across the desk like two generals meeting at a border.

GLORIA
(beat)
You're the grandmother.

GRANDMA JO
(beat)
You're the one who runs this place.

GLORIA
(beat)
Gloria Pettiford. Head nurse. Thirty years.

GRANDMA JO
Josephine Bullock. Fourth grade. Thirty-one.

A beat. They size each other up.

GLORIA
(quietly)
I've known since July, Mrs. Bullock. (beat) He walks like his daddy. (beat) I never said a word.

GRANDMA JO
(beat)
I know you didn't, baby. (beat) He wrote me about you in August. (beat) He said, "There's a nurse here named Gloria who knows everything and says nothing, and she's the reason I'm still standing."

Gloria, who has not been rendered speechless since 1983, is speechless.

GRANDMA JO
(patting the desk, moving on)
Keep doing that. (beat) Raymond, the cafeteria.

END OF ACT TWO

ACT THREE

18 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 5 - DAY
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 12:38 PM

Bunny Washington's abdomen is open. Crump operates. Clayton and Marc assist. In the retroperitoneum, wrapped in a thick, glistening membrane like a sac: the mass, about eighteen centimeters long, fed by a few vessels branching off Bunny's own mesentery.

CRUMP
(working)
Encapsulated. Its own sac. (beat)
Blood supply from two branches of the superior mesenteric. (beat)
Ligate them, Dr. Bullock.

Marc ties off the vessels. Crump dissects the sac free from the bowel, slowly, carefully. Then he lifts it out whole and lays it in a basin.

CRUMP
(quietly)
Open it, Dr. Hartwell. For the pathologist.

Clayton carefully opens the sac. Inside: a small, curled, formless shape. A rudimentary spine. Tiny limb buds. A tuft of dark, curly hair. Two small teeth.

Nobody in the OR says anything.

CLAYTON
(very quietly)
His twin.

MARC
(beat)
He's got hair like him. (beat)
Curly.

The circulating nurse, who has been doing this for twenty years, crosses herself.

CRUMP
(gently)
Thirty-two years. (beat) Close him, gentlemen. (beat) He's been carrying his brother long enough.

19 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - ORTHOPEDICS WORKROOM - DAY

FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 1:15 PM

Camille dictates an op note. Harmony sits on a stool beside her, staring at the bone model on the desk.

CAMILLE
(into the dictaphone)
"...end dictation." (beat, turning to Harmony) Okay, Choir. You've been staring at that femur for ten minutes. (beat) Is it about the rumor?

HARMONY
(beat)
You heard?

CAMILLE
Baby, I heard it in the elevator at seven. (beat) Your roommate is the Chief's son and Victor Donohue's grandson. (beat) So?

HARMONY
(beat)
So I live with him. (beat) For five months. I make him grits every morning. I lent him my umbrella. I... (she stops) And I'm finding out from an elevator.

CAMILLE
(beat, gently)
Choir. (beat) My daddy owns half the hotels in the French Quarter. Or he did, until the water. (beat) Augustin Toussaint. Everybody in New Orleans knows that name. (beat) You know what I did when I matched at Tulane?

HARMONY
What?

CAMILLE
(beat)
I told everybody my daddy was a "hospitality worker." (beat) For three years. (beat) Because I wanted them to see me first. (beat) Money's the least interesting thing about anybody, Choir. But it's the first thing people see. (beat) Maybe he just wanted you to see him first.

Harmony looks at her for a long moment.

HARMONY
(quietly)
I did see him first.

CAMILLE
(beat, softly)
Then you already know who he is. (beat) The rest is just a last name.

20 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - STAIRWELL C - DAY
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 1:42 PM

Raven sits on the stairs. Arianna stands two steps below her. Raven won't look at her.

RAVEN
(quietly)
August ninth. (beat) That's three months.

ARIANNA
(beat)
I know.

RAVEN
(beat)
We've been dating three weeks. You kissed me back in a supply room. (beat) And you knew this the whole time.

ARIANNA
(beat, flat)
It wasn't mine to tell, Raven.

RAVEN
(finally looking at her)
I asked you. In October. I asked you, Harmony asked you, I said "everybody says 'Bullock's a common name' like it's a password." (beat) And you said it to me too. The password.

ARIANNA
(beat)
I said it to Kennerly. To his face. To protect Marc. (beat) "His grandfather drove a bus." (beat) And it's what got Whitlow onto Robert Bullock's CV. (beat) I've been carrying that for a month. (beat) So yes. I kept it. From you too.

Raven stares at her.

ARIANNA
(quietly)
I grew up in a house where everybody told everybody else's secrets when they were drunk. (beat) My father told the whole block my mother was crazy. (beat) I swore I'd never be the person who tells. (beat) Even when it costs me.

RAVEN
(beat)
Did it cost you?

ARIANNA
(beat)
It's costing me right now.

A long silence. Raven looks at her: the hard, flat face that never asks for anything.

RAVEN
(finally, quietly)
If I told you something. (beat) Something big. (beat) Would you keep it?

ARIANNA
(beat)
Forever.

RAVEN
(beat)
Even from Marc?

ARIANNA
(beat)
Even from Marc.

Raven nods slowly.

RAVEN
(standing)
I'm still mad at you. (beat) For about a day.

ARIANNA
(beat)
Only a day?

RAVEN
(walking past her up the stairs)
I'm working on it.

21 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL RECOVERY - BAY 6 - DAY
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 2:31 PM

Bunny Washington, waking up, an NG tube in, his belly suddenly flat under the blankets for the first time in his life. Crump sits by the bed. Marc stands beside him.

BUNNY
(hoarse)
Is it out?

CRUMP
It's out, Mr. Washington. (beat) Eighteen centimeters. (beat) You'll breathe better on those stairs to your shop by Christmas.

Bunny puts a hand on his flat belly under the blanket. He leaves it there.

BUNNY
(beat)
Did he have... (beat) Was there anything? Anything like a person?

MARC
(gently)
Some bones. A little spine. (beat) Two teeth. (beat) And hair. Dark. Curly. (beat) Like yours.

Bunny closes his eyes. A long moment.

BUNNY
(barely)
My mama passed in 2002. She's at Woodlawn. (beat) She always said the other one went back to God. (beat) Can he... (beat) After the pathology. Can I bury him with her?

Crump looks at Marc. Marc nods.

CRUMP
(quietly)
I'll call the pathologist and the funeral home myself, son. (beat) He's going home to your mother.

BUNNY
(crying, smiling)
Thirty-two years he's been riding around with me. (beat) I'm going to give him a name. (beat) Bernard and... Bernardo? No. (beat) Benny. (beat) Bunny and Benny. (beat) She'd have laughed.

22 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - CORRIDOR - DAY
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 2:52 PM

Marc comes out of recovery. Esther is waiting at the end of the corridor. She falls into step beside him. Carefully. Six inches apart.

ESTHER
(quietly)
It's everywhere.

MARC
(beat)
I know. (beat) My grandmother confirmed it in the lobby at full volume.

ESTHER
(almost smiling)
I heard. (beat) Gloria said she called you "baby" so loud they heard it in radiology.

MARC
(beat)
She did.

ESTHER
(beat, serious)
Marc. Raven and Harmony. (beat) Tell them before the blog does. (beat) Please. (beat) Don't let them find out the way you found out about Clayton.

Marc stops walking. He looks at her.

MARC
(quietly)
Tonight. (beat) At the house. (beat) I promised them "soon." (beat) It's soon.

ESTHER
(beat, nodding)
Good.

She keeps walking. He watches her go: the ring on her hand, the boat she still sleeps on half the week. She told him first, on the roof. Now he has to tell somebody first too.

23 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - DAY
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 3:06 PM

Robert (49) reviews a post-op chart. Amond, back on the cardiothoracic service for ten days now, his color good, stands beside him.

ROBERT
(not looking up)
You've heard.

AMOND
(beat)
The respiratory therapists told me at noon. (beat) Then the transport guy. (beat) Then Miss Hattie, who said, quote, "I've known since August, baby, I'm a cook, not a fool."

ROBERT
(beat, almost smiling)
How is he?

AMOND
(beat)
Quiet. (beat) He's taking it the way he took the hallway with Hartwell. (beat) Polite. Steady. (beat) Inside, he's on fire.

ROBERT
(closing the chart)
Like his mother.

AMOND
(beat)
He's going to tell Ellison and Divine tonight. At the house. (beat) His grandmother's cooking.

ROBERT
(beat)
My mother is cooking in his house? (beat) God help that kitchen.

AMOND
(beat)
My mother already labeled it.

ROBERT
(beat)
Then God help both of them. (beat) Dr. Baker. (beat) If it goes badly tonight, bring him to me. Any hour.

AMOND
(beat)
Yes, sir.

24 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - STAIRWELL B - DAY
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 3:14 PM

Marc on the landing. Arianna comes up the stairs, sees him and stops.

ARIANNA
(flat)
Raven knows I knew. (beat) Since August.

MARC
(closing his eyes)
Arianna. I'm sorry. I never meant for you to...

ARIANNA
(cutting him off)
Don't. (beat) I chose to keep it, Bullock. Nobody made me. (beat) I'd do it again. (beat) But tonight you tell them. (beat) Because I'm not carrying it one more day for you, and I'm not losing her over it.

Marc looks at her: the hard face, the scared eyes.

MARC
(quietly)
Tonight. (beat) I swear.

ARIANNA
(beat, walking past him up the stairs)
Good. (beat) And Bullock? (beat) Happy almost-Thanksgiving. (beat) Your secret was a pain in my ass.

MARC
(beat, almost laughing)
Thank you, Gary.

25 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - PELL PAVILION - NURSES' STATION - DAY
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 3:21 PM

Marc comes to the station to sign an order. Kendra Wallace is behind the desk. She sees him and goes red. She stands up.

KENDRA
(quietly)
Dr. Bullock.

MARC
(signing)
Kendra.

KENDRA
(beat)
I'm sorry. (beat) I told the pharmacist. And Deb. And... (beat) I don't even know who else. (beat) Kennerly said it in the cafeteria, and I just... (beat) It was something to talk about.

Marc looks up at her.

MARC
(gently)
You didn't say anything that wasn't true, Kendra.

KENDRA
(beat)
That's not the point.

MARC
(beat)
No. (beat) It's not. (beat) But it's true. (beat) And I'm the one who made it a secret. (beat) That part's mine.

Kendra looks at him for a long moment.

KENDRA
(quietly)
For what it's worth. (beat) Nobody's saying you got anything you didn't earn. (beat) Even the respiratory therapists. (beat) And they hate everybody.

MARC
(almost smiling)
That's very generous of respiratory.

26 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - DR. GRAVES'S OFFICE - DAY

FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 3:38 PM

A spare, immaculate office: neurosurgical atlases, a single orchid, a framed photo of a younger Graves in a Mercer Scholar blazer with Victor Donohue. Graves (52) sits behind his desk. Kennerly stands in front of it.

GRAVES
(without looking up from a scan)
Dr. Kennerly. (beat) You're on probation.

KENNERLY
(stiffly)
Yes, sir.

GRAVES
(beat)
Probation means one more incident of conduct unbecoming and you're gone. (beat) I chaired your hearing. I'd like to be very clear about what "unbecoming" means.

KENNERLY
(beat)
Sir, I didn't say anything untrue.

Graves finally looks up. His eyes are very cold.

GRAVES
(quietly)
Dr. Kennerly. Truth is not a defense for cruelty. (beat) You took something that belonged to another intern, his family, his privacy, his choice about when to tell people, and you set it out in the cafeteria at five fifty-one in the morning, for no reason except that it was something to talk about. (beat) And for a man who sits on the twelfth floor and keeps his own hands clean.

Kennerly doesn't answer.

GRAVES
(beat)
I've worked in this hospital for twenty years. I was a Mercer Scholar. (beat) I've watched men like Dr. Whitlow use boys like you before. (beat) When it goes wrong, and it always does, he won't be in the room. (beat) You will.

KENNERLY
(barely)
Yes, sir.

GRAVES
(going back to the scan)
That's all.

27 INT. MONTY'S ON JACKSON - BAR - DAY
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 4:31 PM

Afternoon. A few regulars. Monty (43) polishes a glass. A REGULAR in a Con Ed jacket, a nurse's husband, leans on the bar.

REGULAR
Monty. (beat) My wife works in Radiology at Grace. (beat) She says the dimple doctor, the one who comes in here, he's a Donohue. (beat) As in the Donohue Donohue. The Foundation.

MONTY
(polishing)
Bullock's a common name.

REGULAR
(laughing)
Not anymore, it isn't. It's all over the hospital. (beat) You knew?

Monty sets down the glass and pours the man another beer, on the house.

MONTY
(pleasantly)
I know the kid drinks club soda with lime. (beat) I know he gave me back my sump pump on time. (beat) I know he says "yes, ma'am" to my mother when she comes in on Sundays. (beat) That's what I know.

REGULAR
(beat, picking up the beer)
You're no fun, Monty.

MONTY
(picking up another glass)
I'm a bartender, Eddie. (beat) I'm a vault with a tap.

28 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF'S OFFICE - DAY
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 4:50 PM

Natasha at her desk. The door opens without a knock. Whitlow, with a cup of tea, wearing an expression of concern.

WHITLOW
Natasha. (beat) I've just heard the most extraordinary rumor about your family. (beat) In the cafeteria, of all places.

NATASHA
(not getting up)
Horace. (beat) You used Kennerly.

WHITLOW
(mildly)
I've said nothing to anyone. (beat) The minutes are sealed. I'm a man of my word.

NATASHA
(standing slowly)
You didn't sign the nondisclosure, Horace. (beat) You didn't have to say anything. You just had to stand near a frightened intern on probation and mention, in passing, what you'd heard in that room. (beat) That's what cowards always say. "I said nothing."

Whitlow's smile doesn't move.

WHITLOW
(pleasantly)
The truth is out, Natasha. (beat) Isn't that what you wanted? "Full disclosure"?

NATASHA
(coming around the desk)
I disclosed to eight trustees, under seal, to protect my son's privacy, Horace. (beat) You disclosed to the cafeteria to destroy it.

WHITLOW
(beat, setting down his tea)
Destroy it? (beat) Your son is now the most famous intern in New York. (beat) Every case he's given, every compliment, every chance to hold a retractor, people will wonder. (beat) That's all. (beat) I didn't have to prove anything. I just had to make them wonder.

He picks up his tea and walks out. Natasha stands in the middle of her office, very still.

END OF ACT THREE

ACT FOUR

29 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - ON-CALL ROOM 2 - DAY
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 5:06 PM

Elxa on the bottom bunk with her feet up. Grandma Jo sits in a plastic chair beside her, shoes off, with a cup of tea from the cafeteria. On Elxa's lap: a postcard. On the front: "GREETINGS FROM ROCKY MOUNT, N.C." On the back, in a teenager's scrawl: "Dr. Bullock. I start school Monday. Grandma made me wear the orange sweater. I look like a traffic cone. I'm alive. Thank you. -Tyrell P. (Bird)"

ELXA
(showing Grandma Jo, smiling)
Sixteen. Shot three times. Grade four liver. (beat) He's in a traffic-cone sweater in North Carolina.

GRANDMA JO
(reading it, delighted)
"I'm alive." (beat) Those are the two most beautiful words a child can write.

Grandma Jo reaches over and puts her small, wrinkled hand flat on Elxa's belly. A beat. A kick.

GRANDMA JO
(triumphant)
A boy. (beat) I told you. That's a boy kick. Your father kicked like that.

ELXA
(laughing)
Grandma.

GRANDMA JO
(beat, softer)
Elxa, baby. (beat) Is your brother going to tell those girls tonight?

ELXA
(beat)
He says he is.

GRANDMA JO
(beat)
Then I'm going to make him the biggest dinner of his life first. (beat) Nobody should tell the truth on an empty stomach.

30 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - NICU - DAY
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 5:24 PM

Malik Ellerbe Jr., three pounds two ounces, in an isolette on CPAP, a tiny knit cap on his head. Nadia, post-op, in a wheelchair, with her hand through the porthole. Malik beside her. Marc and Clayton stand together at the foot of the isolette.

NADIA
(whispering, to the baby)
Hi, baby. (beat) Hi, Malik Junior. (beat) You're so small. (beat) You've been so brave.

MALIK
(to Marc, low)
The NICU doctor said the scar on his back is healing beautifully. (beat) She said she's never seen one before. (beat) She asked who did it.

CLAYTON
(quietly)
Dr. Crump. (beat) And Dr. Bullock caught the cord.

Malik looks at both of them. The fetal surgeon and the intern. The husband and the other man, though he doesn't know that.

MALIK
(beat)
We're having him christened at Bethel in January. (beat) You'll both come. (beat) That's not a question.

MARC
(smiling)
Yes, sir.

CLAYTON
(beat)
I'll be there.

Malik Jr. stretches one impossibly small hand. It grabs Nadia's finger and holds on.

31 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - NIGHT
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 6:14 PM

The kitchen has been taken over. Grandma Jo, in an apron over her church dress, commands the stove: smothered pork chops, collard greens, candied yams, cornbread, the seven-up pound cake on the counter. Amond, sleeves rolled up, chops onions under her direction with surgical precision. Harriet's labels are everywhere. Grandma Jo has written corrections on several of them.

GRANDMA JO
(stirring)
Smaller, baby. You're dicing an onion, not amputating it.

AMOND
(precisely)
They're three-millimeter cubes, Mrs. Bullock.

GRANDMA JO
(peering over)
Hm. (beat) They are, too. (beat) You're a surgeon.

AMOND
(beat)
Cardiothoracic.

GRANDMA JO
My son's thing. (beat) He couldn't dice an onion to save his life. (beat) Keep chopping.

The front door opens. Raven and Harmony come in from the hospital, tired, carrying their bags. They stop at the kitchen doorway, staring at the small, imperious woman at their stove.

GRANDMA JO
(turning, beaming, wooden spoon raised)
You must be Raven. (beat) And you must be Harmony. (beat) Marc-Anthony writes me about you every Sunday. (beat) Come here and let me look at you.

Raven and Harmony exchange a glance. They walk into the kitchen. Grandma Jo looks each of them up and down, the way she's looked at forty years of fourth graders.

GRANDMA JO
(to Raven)
You're the one from Savannah. With the grandmother. (beat) Mine raised me too. (to Harmony) And you're the one who makes grits and sings. (beat) He says you have a voice like Mahalia.

HARMONY
(quietly)
He said that?

GRANDMA JO
(beat, kindly)
He says a lot of things about you, baby. (beat) Wash your hands. Dinner's at seven.

She turns back to the stove. Raven and Harmony look at each other. Then at Amond. Amond keeps dicing onions, very, very intently.

32 EXT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - BACK PORCH - NIGHT
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 6:43 PM

The little back porch, where Marc takes his phone calls. He sits on the steps. His phone rings: "GRACE."

MARC
(answering)
Gracie.

GRACE (V.O.)
(on the phone, fast, nervous, twenty-four)
Elxa called me at lunch. She said Grandma confirmed everything in the lobby at a volume detectable from Boston. (beat) Are you okay? I made a list of things to say, but I can't find it, it's somewhere in my anatomy notes, I'm in the library...

MARC
(smiling despite himself)
I'm okay, Gracie.

GRACE (V.O.)
(beat)
Liar. (beat) You're telling your roommates tonight, aren't you.

MARC
(beat)
How do you know that?

GRACE (V.O.)
(beat)
Because you've been saying "soon" since October twentieth, and you never say "soon" for more than two weeks. I made a chart in 1994. (beat) Marc. (beat) Tell them about me too. (beat) Tell them I'm the good Bullock.

MARC
(laughing)
I'll tell them you're the good Bullock.

GRACE (V.O.)
(beat, softer)
And tell them you're the bravest one. (beat) I'm not just saying that because I'm your sister. (beat) I'm saying it because I've watched you be scared of being somebody's grandson my whole life, and you went and became a doctor anyway, in a building with Mama in it. (beat) That's very brave, Marc. That's insane, but it's brave.

Marc closes his eyes, smiling.

MARC
(quietly)
Love you, Gracepedia.

GRACE (V.O.)
(beat)
Love you. (beat) Go eat Grandma's pork chops. I can smell them from here.

33 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - DINING ROOM - NIGHT
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 7:31 PM

The dining room table, for the first time since the housewarming, full. Empty plates, scraped clean. The pound

cake half gone. Grandma Jo sits at the head. Marc at the other end. Raven and Harmony on one side, Amond on the other. Arianna arrived at 7:15 and sits beside Raven, carefully not touching her.

Marc puts down his fork. Grandma Jo sees it. She stands, picks up her plate and Amond's, and nods at Amond. Amond stands too, and Arianna, and the three of them go into the kitchen. The door swings shut.

Marc, Raven and Harmony are alone at the table.

MARC
(quietly)
I promised you "soon." (beat) You've been hearing it all day from other people. (beat) I'm sorry. (beat) You should have heard it from me. (beat) Months ago.

Raven and Harmony wait.

MARC
(taking a breath)
My mother is Dr. Natasha Donohue. (beat) My father is Dr. Robert Bullock. (beat) Dr. Elxa Bullock is my big sister. (beat) My little sister Grace is at Harvard Medical School. (beat) And my mother's father, my grandfather, is Dr. Victor Donohue.

Silence. Raven's face does something complicated: not surprise, but the end of a long ache.

MARC
(beat)
That was him, on August ninth. At the loading dock. He arranged the astronaut for Kingston. (beat) That was him, in the Mercedes, in the rain, on October eighth. (beat) This house is his. (beat) The man in the suit with the envelopes works for him. (beat) The "Yes, sir" calls on the porch. (beat) Him.

RAVEN
(very quietly)
I knew. (beat) I knew it. I didn't know it, but I knew it.

MARC
(beat)
I know you did, Rave. (beat) You asked me in a supply room in September. (beat) I didn't answer.

Harmony hasn't said a word. She's looking at the table.

MARC
(to Harmony, softer)
Double-O.

HARMONY
(finally, very quietly)
Five months. (beat) I've lived in your house for five months, Marc. (beat) I make you grits. I bring you coffee on the stoop at five in the morning. I held you in a stairwell on October eleventh. (beat) And I found out from an elevator.

MARC
(barely)
I know.

HARMONY
(looking up at him, eyes bright)
Why? (beat) Why couldn't you tell me? (beat) Of all the people in this building. (beat) Me.

Marc looks at her. The true answer is right there, and it's the hardest one he has.

MARC
(quietly)
Because you were the one person in my life who liked me before you knew. (beat) And I was scared that once you knew, I'd never be sure again.

Harmony stares at him. A tear runs down her cheek. She stands up.

HARMONY
(barely)
I need to walk.

MARC
(standing)
Harmony...

HARMONY
(at the door, not turning around)
Don't follow me, Marc. (beat) Please.

The front door opens and closes. Raven sits at the table looking at Marc. In the kitchen doorway, Grandma Jo stands with a dish towel in her hands. She heard every word.

END OF ACT FOUR

ACT FIVE

34 EXT. GANTRY PLAZA STATE PARK - PIER - NIGHT
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 8:16 PM

The end of the pier. The Pepsi-Cola sign glowing red. Manhattan blazing across the river. Harmony sits on the edge of the pier with her knees pulled up, her phone in her hand. She dials.

HARMONY
(into the phone, small)
Camille. (beat) It's Choir. (beat) Are you busy?

Ten minutes later, footsteps on the pier. Camille, in her Saints jacket, sits down beside her without a word. She holds out a paper bag: two beignets from a cart on Vernon.

CAMILLE
(quietly)
Not real beignets. (beat) Real beignets don't exist north of Baton Rouge. (beat) But they're close.

Harmony takes one. She doesn't eat it.

HARMONY
(beat)
He told us. (beat) All of it. (beat) And I walked out.

CAMILLE
(beat)
Why did you walk out?

HARMONY
(beat)
Because he said he didn't tell me because I was the one person who liked him before I knew. (beat) And he was scared he'd never be sure again. (beat) And I didn't know whether to hug him or hit him.

CAMILLE
(beat, gently)
Choir. (beat) Is it just the secret? (beat) Or is it him?

Harmony looks at her. Camille holds her gaze. Camille isn't stupid either.

HARMONY
(barely)
I don't know anymore.

CAMILLE
(beat, looking out at the water)
Okay. (beat) That's an honest answer. (beat) I'll take an honest "I don't know" over a pretty lie any day.

She puts her arm around Harmony. Harmony leans into her and finally eats the not-quite-a-beignet.

35 INT. ARIANNA'S APARTMENT - ABOVE THE BAKERY - ASTORIA - NIGHT
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 8:49 PM

A small, spare rented room above a Greek bakery on 30th Avenue. A mattress on a frame, a desk with a lamp and Sabiston's Surgery, a hot plate, a framed photo of two small children in Gary. The smell of bread comes up through the floor. Raven sits on the bed. Arianna stands by the window.

RAVEN
(looking around)
It smells like heaven in here.

ARIANNA
(beat)
They start at three a.m. (beat) I haven't needed an alarm clock since July.

A beat. Raven looks at her hands.

RAVEN
(quietly)
I said if I told you something big, would you keep it. (beat) You said forever.

ARIANNA
(beat)
I meant forever.

RAVEN
(beat)
My mother isn't dead. (beat) I let people think she's dead. At Morehouse. Here. (beat) She's alive. In Savannah. In a little apartment on MLK Boulevard. (beat) She's been clean three years. (beat) She writes me a letter every month. (beat) I have thirty-four of them in a shoebox under my bed. I've never opened one.

Arianna turns from the window.

RAVEN
(beat, barely)
Not one. (beat) Because if I open one, and she's changed, then I have to forgive her. (beat) And if I open one, and she hasn't, then I was right to hate her, and I don't want to be right.

Arianna crosses the room and sits beside her on the bed. She doesn't say anything clever. She takes Raven's hand.

ARIANNA
(quietly)
My mother doesn't know what year it is. (beat) She asks my sister when I'm coming home from school. (beat) I've been gone eleven years. (beat) Some days I'd give anything for a letter. (beat) Even one I couldn't open.

RAVEN
(crying)
Don't tell Marc.

ARIANNA
(beat)
I won't. (beat) Forever.

36 EXT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - STOOP - NIGHT
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 9:34 PM

Marc sits on the stoop in a sweatshirt. Grandma Jo comes out in her coat with two cups of tea and sits down beside him. Slowly. Her knees crack.

GRANDMA JO
(handing him a cup)
She'll come back.

MARC
(beat)
You don't know that, Grandma.

GRANDMA JO
(beat)
Baby, I taught fourth grade at Garnet-Patterson for thirty-one years. (beat) I know who comes back. (beat) That girl's coming back.

They sip their tea. A 7 train rumbles in the distance.

GRANDMA JO
(beat)
You know what Mrs. Parks said, about the bus? (beat) Everybody thinks she sat down because her feet hurt. (beat) She said no. She said, "The only tired I was, was tired of giving in."

MARC
(quietly)
I know the quote, Grandma.

GRANDMA JO
(beat)
Then hear it. (beat) For five months you've been giving in. To the policy. To your grandfather's lawyers. To your mother's fears. To your own. (beat) "Bullock's a common name." (beat) Tonight you stopped giving in. (beat) That girl walking out doesn't change that.

MARC
(beat)
It feels like it does.

GRANDMA JO
(beat)
The truth costs something, baby. Every time. (beat) That's how you know it's the truth. (beat) Lies are always on sale.

Marc laughs despite himself. She pats his knee.

GRANDMA JO
(beat)
Your grandfather Walter drove the 70 bus up Georgia Avenue for thirty years. (beat) He'd have liked that girl. (beat) He liked people who walked out of rooms when they needed to. (beat) He said it meant they'd walk back in on purpose.

37 INT. CLAYTON'S SUBLET - BROOKLYN HEIGHTS - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 10:04 PM

Esther comes in carrying a cardboard box: books, a framed photo of five sisters, a coffee mug that says "BU NEUROSCIENCE." The first box from the Clarence. She sets it on the floor. Clayton, at the desk, looks up.

CLAYTON
(softly)
Es.

ESTHER
(beat)
One box. (beat) It's not moving in. It's one box.

CLAYTON
(beat)
One box is a lot.

ESTHER
(beat)
Did you call Malcolm?

CLAYTON
(beat)
At six. (beat) I told him no. (beat) I told him you don't want him in New York. Not yet. Maybe not ever. (beat) Your words.

ESTHER
(beat)
What did he say?

CLAYTON
(beat)
He said, "Tell her I'm sorry. Tell her I'll wait." (beat) And then he said, "Tell her Mama Corinne's been asking where I've been on Sundays." (beat) And then he hung up, because he was crying.

Esther sits down on the arm of the couch. She looks at the box.

ESTHER
(quietly)
He used to eat Sunday dinner at our house every week. From 1978. (beat) He was ten.

CLAYTON
(beat)
I know.

ESTHER
(beat)
Thank you for telling me. (beat) Again.

CLAYTON
(beat)
That's the deal. (beat) The day it happens.

38 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF OF MEDICINE'S OFFICE - NIGHT
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 10:38 PM

Whitlow at his desk under the banker's lamp. On his computer screen: QueensGraceConfidential. A new post. Headline: "IS DR. X THE CHIEF'S SON?" Comments: 1,442.

He reads it, smiling. Then he takes a fresh legal pad out of his drawer and writes at the top: "JOINT COMMISSION -- ANONYMOUS -- CONFLICT OF INTEREST / RESIDENT SUPERVISION." He underlines it twice.

WHITLOW
(to himself, softly)
Now everyone will be watching. (beat) And when everyone is watching, eventually somebody sees something.

He turns off the lamp.

39 INT. NATASHA AND ROBERT'S BROWNSTONE - RIVERSIDE DRIVE - KITCHEN - NIGHT
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 10:51 PM

Natasha and Robert at the island with two glasses of wine. Natasha's cell phone is on speaker between them.

VICTOR (V.O.)
(on speaker)
The cafeteria. (beat) Horace used the cafeteria.

NATASHA
(tired)
And Josephine finished the job in the lobby. At full volume.

VICTOR (V.O.)
(a delighted laugh)
Josephine Bullock. (beat) God bless that woman. (beat) She's the only person who has ever made me feel like I owed her an apology for something I didn't do.

ROBERT
(dry)
She does that to everybody, Victor.

VICTOR (V.O.)
(beat)
And Marc told his roommates?

NATASHA
(beat)
Tonight. At dinner. Josephine cooked. (beat) Harmony walked out. Raven stayed.

VICTOR (V.O.)
(beat, quietly)
Then I'm coming for Thanksgiving. (beat) To the house. (beat) If they're going to know who I am, Tasha, they should meet me with a pie in my hands, not in the back of a Mercedes.

Natasha and Robert look at each other.

ROBERT
(beat)
Victor. You've never cooked anything in your life.

VICTOR (V.O.)
(beat)
I said "in my hands," Robert. (beat) I didn't say I'd bake it.

END OF ACT FIVE

TAG

40 EXT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - STOOP - NIGHT
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 11:41 PM

Grandma Jo has gone to bed in the spare room. Marc sits alone on the stoop. Footsteps on the sidewalk. He looks up. Harmony, her hands in her pockets, stops at the bottom of the steps.

A long silence.

HARMONY
(quietly)
I'm still mad at you.

MARC
(beat)
Okay.

HARMONY
(beat)
You're an idiot, Marc-Anthony Bullock. (beat) Donohue. (beat) Whatever.

MARC
(beat)
I know.

HARMONY
(climbing the steps, sitting down beside him)
I liked you before I knew. (beat) And I like you after I know. (beat) I'm going to like you tomorrow too, and that's going to make me furious for about a week.

Marc looks at her. His eyes are wet.

MARC
(barely)
Double-O.

HARMONY
(beat, leaning her head on his shoulder)
You don't ever get to be unsure of me, Marc. (beat) Not because of a last name. (beat) Not because of a Mercedes. (beat) I'm not going anywhere.

He puts his arm around her. They sit on the stoop.

MARC (V.O.)
A hospital is a building full of people who keep secrets for a living.

41 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - UPSTAIRS HALLWAY - NIGHT
FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 4, 2005 - 11:56 PM

The hallway. On the wall: the framed countdown from Kingston's room, and Crump's bow tie. Raven, in her bonnet, stands at her bedroom door, listening to the murmur of voices on the stoop below. She smiles and closes her door.

MARC (V.O.)
And every one of us learns the same thing eventually.

In the spare room, Grandma Jo lies in bed, her Rosa Parks funeral program on the nightstand, her eyes open, listening too. She smiles.

MARC (V.O.)
The secret isn't the thing people talk about. (beat) The secret is just the thing you didn't say.

In his room, Amond, at his desk with a cardiac journal, hears the front door close and two sets of footsteps on the stairs. He doesn't look up. But he turns the page.

MARC (V.O.)
What they talk about is what you do once it's out.

FADE OUT.

END OF EPISODE

Media Companion: Episode 2x07

Off-screen media around the episode, in chronological order. Not counted in page length (MA-009 §5).

THE NEW YORK TIMES: "ROSA PARKS IS LAID TO REST IN DETROIT"

Thursday, November 3, 2005

"DETROIT -- Rosa Parks was buried Wednesday after a seven-hour funeral... Her body had lain in honor in the Capitol Rotunda in Washington on Sunday and Monday, the first woman so honored, as tens of thousands waited in line in the cold..."

ASSOCIATED PRESS: "PROTESTS GREET BUSH AT SUMMIT IN ARGENTINA" / "RIOTS SPREAD IN PARIS SUBURBS"

Friday, November 4, 2005

"MAR DEL PLATA, Argentina (AP) -- Thousands of protesters marched against President Bush as the Summit of the Americas opened..." / "PARIS (AP) -- Rioting spread for an eighth night across the suburbs of Paris..."

QueensGraceConfidential (Blogger)

Friday, November 4, 2005, 4:02 PM

"IS DR. X THE CHIEF'S SON? We have held this story since July out of respect. Today it walked into our lobby in a church hat and called him 'baby' loud enough to be heard in Radiology. So: Dr. X is apparently Dr. Natasha Donohue's son, Dr. Elxa Bullock's brother, and (sit down) VICTOR DONOHUE's GRANDSON. Living in Hunters Point. With roommates. Taking the 7. We'll say what everybody in this building is saying: nobody can point to one thing he's gotten that he didn't earn. Also, a man had his TWIN removed from his abdomen today. Something to talk about indeed." Comments (1,442).

Postcard: Tyrell Pickens to Dr. Elxa Bullock

Postmarked Rocky Mount, N.C., October 31, 2005

"Dr. Bullock. I start school Monday. Grandma made me wear the orange sweater. I look like a traffic cone. I'm alive. Thank you. -Tyrell P. (Bird)"

SMS, Motorola RAZR (Raven Ellison to Harmony Divine)

Friday, November 4, 2005, 8:10 AM

Raven: "its everywhere. chiefs son. elxas brother. donohue."

Harmony: "stairwell B. now."

Whitlow's legal pad (top sheet)

Friday, November 4, 2005, 10:38 PM

"JOINT COMMISSION -- ANONYMOUS -- CONFLICT OF INTEREST / RESIDENT SUPERVISION." (underlined twice)

Continuity Sheet: Episode 2x07

New Canon Established

- **The rumor:** at 5:51 AM, November 4, 2005, Kennerly told Kendra Wallace and Dr. Philip Grant in the cafeteria that Marc is the Chief's son and Victor's grandson, 'from a board member.' By noon it had reached the pharmacy, respiratory therapy and every nurses' station. Whitlow did not sign the board NDA (department chiefs weren't asked), so he is legally clear and deniable. Natasha: 'You disclosed to the cafeteria to destroy it.' Whitlow: 'I just had to make them wonder.' **Whitlow is now drafting an anonymous Joint Commission complaint** (conflict of interest and resident supervision).
- **Grandma Jo Bullock's on-screen debut** (74; retired fourth-grade teacher at Garnet-Patterson in Shaw for 31 years). She came from D.C. after Rosa Parks lay in honor (she waited four hours outside the Rotunda on Sunday, October 30). **She confirmed the rumor in the lobby** ('MARC-ANTHONY! Come give your grandmother some sugar!'), and Whitlow watched from the mezzanine. 'Lies are always on sale.' Walter Bullock drove the 70 bus up Georgia Avenue. Natasha sent Big Ray to Penn Station. Grandma Jo predicts Elxa's baby is a boy (Tuck is). Gloria and Grandma Jo met.
- **MARC TOLD RAVEN AND HARMONY** at dinner (7:31 PM, after Grandma Jo's pork chops): Natasha and Robert are his parents, Elxa and Grace his sisters, and Victor his grandfather. Victor was the one at the loading dock and in the Mercedes, and the house is Victor's. Raven: 'I knew it. I didn't know it, but I knew it.' Harmony: 'Five months... I found out from an elevator.' Marc: 'Because you were the one person in my life who liked me before you knew.' Harmony walked out (to Camille at Gantry pier), came back at 11:41 PM and said: 'I'm not going anywhere.' **The heir designation was not revealed.**
- **Raven learned Arianna had known since August 9**, and the two made up. **Raven's secret** (told only to Arianna, who keeps it even from Marc): her mother is alive, three years clean, in an apartment on MLK Boulevard in Savannah, and has written monthly. Raven has 34 unopened letters in a shoebox under her bed.
- **Esther and Clayton:** Malcolm Sloan called Clayton at 11:15 PM on November 3 about a possible NYU plastic surgery job. Clayton disclosed it the same day, and at Esther's request told Malcolm no ('not yet, maybe not ever'). Malcolm: 'Tell her I'll wait.' He has eaten Sunday dinner at the Smilleys' since 1978. **Esther brought her first box from the Clarence** to the Remsen Street sublet: 'It's not moving in. It's one box.'
- **Malik Ellerbe Jr.** was born by cesarean at 30w6d for chorioamnionitis, 3 lb 2 oz, Apgars 5 and 8, with a healed sacrococcygeal scar from fetal surgery. Christening at Bethel in January; Marc and Clayton are invited. Clayton: 'First open fetal I've done that I got to meet.'
- **Bunny Washington** had an 18 cm fetus in fetu resected (Crump; Clayton; Marc), with vertebrae, limb buds, two teeth and curly hair. It will be buried with his mother (d. 2002) at Woodlawn under the name 'Benny.'
- **Graves warned Kennerly**: 'Truth is not a defense for cruelty.' Graves's office holds a photo of him as a Mercer Scholar with Victor. **Lowery** called Raven and Arianna's quarrel a 'lovers' quarrel,' so he knows. Monty: 'I'm a vault with a tap.' Kendra apologized to Marc.

- **Victor will come to Thanksgiving at 49th Avenue** (November 24) 'with a pie in my hands' (he won't bake it). Grace called Marc: 'Tell them I'm the good Bullock.'

Knowledge Tracker (as of November 4, 2005)

Group	Knows Marc is Natasha and Robert's son and Victor's grandson?
Raven, Harmony	Yes, told by Marc at 7:31 PM
QGH staff at large	Rumor confirmed in practice by the blog and the lobby; not officially announced
Board (8), Bassett, Whitlow, Lowery, Kennerly	Yes
Clayton	Now effectively yes (everyone knows)
Heir designation (2001 will and sealed letter)	Still secret: Victor, Marc, V.J., the Foundation board and Natasha
Julian Whitmore	Does not know (per C-073)

Patient Registry

Patient	DOB / age	Diagnosis	Procedure / surgeon	Outcome
Bernard 'Bunny' Washington	4/19/1973 (32)	Fetus in fetu, 18 cm, retroperitoneal, encapsulated	Excision (Crump; Clayton; Marc)	Recovering; burial with his mother
Nadia Ellerbe	4/25/1977 (28)	Chorioamnionitis at 30w6d after PPROM and open fetal surgery	Repeat cesarean through the hysterotomy scar (Clayton; Marc)	Stable
Malik Ellerbe Jr.	11/4/2005	Prematurity, 30w6d; post-fetal SCT resection	NICU, CPAP	Stable; home by Christmas expected
Lap chole patient	-	Cholelithiasis	Lap cholecystectomy (Lowery; Raven, Arianna)	Uncomplicated

New Characters

- **Bernard 'Bunny' Washington** (b. April 19, 1973), a Lenox Avenue barber. **Dr. Philip Grant** (b. March 13, 1976), a medicine resident. **Eddie** (b. 1965), a Monty's regular married to a Radiology tech.
- **Josephine 'Grandma Jo' Bullock** and **Dr. Grace Bullock** (voice) make their on-screen debuts (already in MA-005). **Malik Ellerbe Jr.** (b. November 4, 2005).

Real-World Accuracy Notes

- Rosa Parks died October 24, 2005, lay in honor in the Capitol Rotunda on October 30-31 (the first woman so honored), had a memorial at Metropolitan A.M.E. in Washington on October 31, and was buried in Detroit on November 2. Her quote: 'The only tired I was, was tired of giving in.' On November 4, 2005, the Summit of the Americas opened in Mar del Plata amid protests, and riots were in their eighth night in the Paris suburbs. Metrobus route 70 runs on Georgia Avenue.

- Medicine: fetus in fetu occurs in about 1 in 500,000 births. It is a vertebrate parasitic twin, usually retroperitoneal and encapsulated, distinguished from teratoma by an axial skeleton. Chorioamnionitis after PPROM is an indication for delivery. A 30-week neonate typically needs CPAP and goes home around 36-37 weeks corrected. Repeat cesarean after a classical hysterotomy is mandatory.